

On Cue — Production Workflow Brief

Fictional prototype notice: This document uses a fully fictional scenario. It is not based on an actual show, call sheet, cast, crew, location, or internal production workflow.

Purpose

On Cue is a role-based “next action” layer for a television shoot day. It helps people understand what they personally need to do to support the current setup and next camera roll, without requiring them to sort through every production detail.

The official call sheet remains the daily operational reference. On Cue is a focused coordination interface around approved information and live status updates.

The principle

People need the right information at the right moment—not all the information all the time.

Before the shoot

A future On Cue implementation could ingest approved information from a call sheet, shooting schedule, scene breakdown, location plan, or manually entered shoot-day plan. The information is reviewed by an authorized production user before becoming active.

The system organizes approved information into:

- Shoot day
- Scene
- Setup
- Location
- Role assignment
- Department task
- Target time
- Readiness status

During the shoot

Each user opens **My Day**. The view is different for each role.

Gaffer example

CURRENT SETUP

Scene 42 • Setup 14B • Loft Kitchen

YOUR ACTION

Adjust key light for Mark 2

Target ready: 10:40 AM

STATUS

Lighting adjustment in progress

ACTIONS

[Lighting Ready] [Need 5 Minutes] [Equipment Issue]

The Gaffer does not need private wardrobe notes, talent logistics, or broad production-management data.

Wardrobe example

CURRENT NEED

Detective Vale • Scene 42 • Look 3

CONTINUITY

- Coat damp at left shoulder
- Left cuff rolled once

YOUR ACTION

Confirm actor is continuity-ready

ACTIONS

[Actor Ready] [Continuity Issue] [Reset Needed]

Wardrobe does not need lighting equipment or power information.

1st AD example

SETUP 14B – HOLD

READY

- Camera
- Sound
- Set / Props

WAITING

- Lighting: ETA 3 min
- Talent: ETA 4 min

PREDICTED ROLL

10:42 AM

[Send Check-In] [Reorder Next Setup] [Approve Camera Roll]

The 1st AD sees department-level readiness. Private notes remain restricted.

When a take needs a reset

1. An authorized user records the take outcome and selects a simple cause category.
2. The control harness checks the user's permission and determines which roles are responsible.
3. The correct departments receive task cards.
4. Each department can mark Ready, Need Time, or Report an Issue.
5. On Cue updates the 1st AD's department-level readiness summary.
6. Once required departments are ready, the system shows **Ready for AD Approval**.
7. The 1st AD—not On Cue—chooses whether to approve camera roll.

Example: actor reset + lighting adjustment

TAKE 5 RESULT

Reset required

Causes: Actor reset; lighting adjustment

ROUTED ACTIONS

Gaffer → Adjust key light for Mark 2

Wardrobe → Confirm Look 3 continuity

Talent Support → Bring performer to set-ready state

AWARENESS ONLY

Director → Setup remains on hold

Camera → Setup remains on hold

AD VIEW

Hold reason: Lighting and Talent

Predicted roll: 10:42 AM

What stays human

On Cue does not replace production judgment. Human authority remains with the people already responsible for the work:

- Department leads own department readiness.
- The Script Supervisor/authorized user records take outcomes.
- The 1st AD controls the transition to camera roll.
- The Director controls creative choices.
- Production leadership controls approved plans and data access.

What is deliberately excluded

- Performance scoring
- Automated blame or causal claims about individuals
- Private talent/crew data outside authorized roles
- Payroll, contracts, medical information, or union information
- Autonomous instructions that override human authority